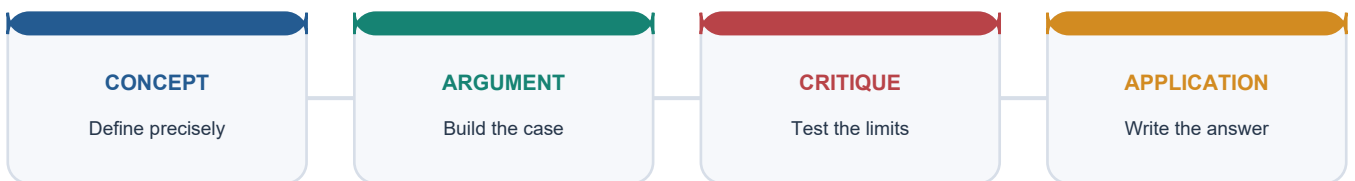


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

UPSC Qualifying English - Practice Solutions

UPSC qualifying-language subject package | Practice Solutions | Official syllabus to timed remediation

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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UPSC Qualifying English - Practice Solutions

Matching keys, model responses and self-marking guidance for every paper in the practice workbook.

PACKAGE NAVIGATION

- **This document:** Practice Solutions
- **Companion Guide:** Qualifying-English_Complete-Skills-Guide.md
- **Question-only Workbook:** Qualifying-English_Practice-Workbook.md
- **Separate Solutions:** Qualifying-English_Practice-Solutions.md
- **Source map:** each numbered Part below names its authoritative source owner; practice-paper and solution Part numbers match one-to-one.
- **Approval:** false until this exact generation is explicitly approved.

PART 01 - English Grammar and Usage Foundation Test - Key and Marking Rules

Award credit for any grammatically correct answer that preserves the stated meaning. This key identifies a preferred examination form; it does not turn accepted modern formal English into an error.

One-to-one coverage ledger

Workbook section	Items	Solutions supplied
A	6	6
B	10	10
C	14	14
D	10	10
E	10	10
F	10	10
G	5	5
H	10	10
I	10	10

A. Function in context

1. noun
2. pronoun
3. adjective
4. adverb
5. verb
6. determiner

B. Nouns and pronouns

1. *One of the applicants has withdrawn.* [AGR/CNT]
2. *The police are investigating the complaint.* [AGR]
3. *She gave me two useful pieces of advice.* [CNT]
4. *We bought three pieces of furniture for the office.* [CNT]
5. *Between you and me, the proposal is unsafe.* [PRO]
6. *Every applicant must bring their identity card.* [PRO/CNT] The singular

possessive must match the one card required from each applicant. his or her and a clear plural recast also receive credit.

7. *The report that identified the error was published yesterday.* [REL]
8. No change: the clause identifies which candidates. [PRO/REL]
9. *The committee has submitted its report as one body.* [AGR]
10. *The scissors are on the table.* [AGR]

C. Agreement, tense, conditionals, articles and determiners

1. *A number of students are absent.* [AGR]
2. *Neither the manager nor the clerks are ready.* [AGR]
3. *The news is encouraging.* [AGR]
4. *She finished the report yesterday.* [TNS]
5. *By the time we arrived, the meeting had already ended.* [TNS]
6. *I know the answer now.* [TNS]
7. *If I had known, I would have called.* [COND]
8. *If she had accepted the post, she would live in Mumbai now.* [COND]
9. *When I arrive, I will call you.* [TNS]
10. *He went to the hospital to visit his friend.* [ART]
11. *She is a teacher in a village school.* [ART]
12. *Honesty is the best policy.* [ART]
13. No change. Few means scarcely any; a few means some. [ART]
14. No change: article choice follows sound. [ART]

D. Prepositions, verb patterns, phrasal verbs, conjunctions and modifiers

1. *She agreed to the proposal.* [PREP]
2. *The officer discussed the proposal.* [PREP]
3. *The unit comprises five sections. / The unit consists of five sections.*
[PREP]
4. *I have been waiting for three hours.* [PREP]
5. *We must comply with the order.* [PREP]
6. *The office provided meals for/to the workers.* [PREP]
7. *She turned it down without explanation.* [PHR]
8. *Although it was late, they continued.* [CONJ]
9. *The job requires planning, coordination and monitoring.* [PAR]
10. *While I was walking to the office, it began to rain.* [MOD] Equivalent
repairs that give the walker as the modifier's subject receive credit.

E. Punctuation, capitals and spelling

1. *After the interview, we returned home.*
2. *The proposal was ambitious; however, it lacked funding.* A full stop before
However is also accepted.
3. *The reports that were incomplete were returned.* No commas: the clause is
restrictive.
4. *Riya has only one brother, who lives in Pune.*

5. *The causes of the crisis are unemployment, inflation and weak demand.*

A consistent serial comma is also accepted.

6. *The officer's report was delayed.*

7. *No, the answer is not correct.*

8. *The inquiry had one conclusion: postpone the launch.*

9. *It's important to check every candidate's identity card.*

10. *The accommodation was definitely insufficient.*

F. Word formation, confusables and exact vocabulary

1. decision 2. alleviate 3. discreet 4. affect 5. stationery

6. principle 7. *abundant; plentiful* is accepted in a suitable sense

8. *wise or judicious*; another exact formal near-synonym is accepted

9. Award one mark only where the sentence shows "practicable/capable of being done": e.g., *The engineer proved that the bridge was feasible within the budget.*

10. Award one mark only where it means improperly reducing standards to save time/money: e.g., *The contractor cut corners on safety.*

G. Correction and accepted variants

1. **Acceptable.** Singular *their* is accepted modern formal English; *'his or her'* or plural recasting is also correct. [VAR]

2. ****Acceptable** in modern English, but avoid in a conservative correction test.** Preferred safe rewrite: *The reason is that funding was delayed.* Do not call the original objectively ungrammatical. [VAR]

3. **Acceptable.** *Angry at the contractor and angry with the contractor* are both standard. [VAR]

4. **Acceptable**, especially in North American usage. Conservative Indian formal alternatives: *provided the workers with meals / provided meals for the workers.* [VAR]

5. **Acceptable.** The collective noun refers to members acting separately; the plural pronoun matches. [VAR]

H. Transformations

1. *No sooner had the meeting ended than the members left.*

2. *Unless you revise, you will forget the rules.*

3. *The box is too heavy for me to lift.*

4. *In spite of being tired, he continued working.* / *In spite of the fact that he was tired, he continued working.*

5. *The accused was arrested by the police.* Agent omission is accepted.

6. *Riya was given a prize by the board.* / *A prize was given to Riya by the board.*

7. *He said (that) he was ready.* *is ready* may be accepted if the report is immediate and the state continues; the context should normally decide.

8. *The teacher asked/told Riya not to leave early.*

9. *The guide said that the Earth moves around the Sun.*

10. *Ravi solved only the problem.* Award only if the revised sentence clearly limits Ravi's action/object rather than the solver.

I. Meaning, use and tags

For 1-5, award one mark only for both a correct meaning and natural use:

1. *at sea* = confused/uncertain.
2. *a thorn in the flesh* = persistent source of irritation.
3. *move heaven and earth* = make every possible effort.
4. *A stitch in time saves nine* = prompt action prevents a larger problem.
5. *All that glitters is not gold* = appearances can mislead.
6. *won't they?* 7. *shall we?* 8. *is she?* 9. *will you?*
10. *isn't there?*

Scoring and diagnosis

Score **85**. For B-H, withhold credit only for a changed meaning, a grammatical error, or a form outside the acceptance guidance above. Record the question number and error code. The retry thresholds in the test apply to the revised 85-mark total as follows: **77-85** proceed; **68-76** targeted retry; **below 68** or a critical-section zero requires Core review and a fresh timed attempt. Two consecutive 77+ attempts are required before the full mock.

PART 02 - English Full-Length Mock 1 - Key and Rubric

One-to-one coverage ledger

Workbook unit	Items/options	Solutions supplied
Q1 essay choices	4	4 full coaching models
Q2 comprehension	5	5 passage-grounded answers
Q3 precis	1	1 counted model
Q4A / Q4B / Q4C / Q4D	10 / 5 / 5 / 5	10 / 5 / 5 / 5
Q5A / Q5B / Q5C / Q5D	10 / 5 / 5 / 5	10 / 5 / 5 / 5

These are coaching solutions and accepted-answer ranges, not an official UPSC key.

Q1. Essay: anchored internal bands

Criterion	80-100	60-79	Below 60
Relevance and thesis (20)	Direct, qualified thesis sustained	Relevant but broad or uneven	Drifts, repeats prompt or takes no position
Organisation (20)	Logical continuous argument; purposeful paragraphs	Basic sequence with repetition	List-like or disordered
Development and balance (25)	Mechanisms, safe examples and genuine limitation	Some explanation, thin balance	Assertion, padding or invented evidence
Grammar and vocabulary (25)	Consistently clear and controlled	Noticeable but non-blocking errors	Persistent errors obscure meaning
Conclusion and count (10)	Reasoned verdict; about 600 words	Abrupt or imprecise count	No conclusion or serious length failure

Prompt-specific planning anchors

These are planning routes, not memorisable essays. No Core model answers any Mock 1 prompt; score the script by the band descriptors rather than phrase matching.

Prompt	Qualified thesis	Four distinct moves
Convenience without responsibility...	Convenience can improve access, but citizenship weakens when people enjoy public benefits while disregarding their shared costs.	access; hidden costs; habits of responsibility; fair institutional design
Efficiency is not the same as effectiveness.	Efficiency conserves time and resources, but effectiveness asks whether the intended public or human outcome has actually been achieved.	distinction; useful speed; proxy/measurement risk; outcome-based correction
Certainty can be a barrier to learning.	Provisional confidence permits action, but unexamined certainty closes inquiry, evidence and correction.	value of conviction; how certainty blocks listening; disciplined doubt; reasoned conclusion
Reading is an exercise in freedom.	Reading enlarges freedom by revealing alternatives, although this depends on literacy, time and intellectual openness.	imagination; independent judgement; access limits; responsible freedom

Model-quality paragraph, not a prewritten essay: *An office may process a large number of applications quickly and still fail the people it serves. If applicants receive automatic messages but cannot correct an error, the system has become efficient at movement rather than effective at service. Speed remains valuable because delay has costs; however, the relevant test is whether the application reaches a fair and usable outcome. Measures should therefore track completion and correction, not merely disposal.* This models claim -> mechanism -> illustration -> qualification. It must be adapted, not copied.

Full coaching model 1 - Convenience without responsibility weakens citizenship

Convenience is one of the benefits of an organised society. Public transport, digital payments, doorstep delivery and online public services save time and make opportunities available to people who live far from offices or markets. The problem begins when convenience is treated as freedom from every duty. Citizenship weakens when people expect shared systems to serve them while ignoring the costs, rules and cooperation that keep those systems usable.

The simplest example is a public place. A clean park is convenient because many people share the cost of maintaining it. If each visitor leaves waste for someone else, individual convenience produces collective disorder. The same logic applies to roads, water and public transport. A person may save a minute by breaking a queue or ignoring a traffic rule, but the accumulated result is delay and danger for everyone. Responsibility converts a public facility from something merely consumed into something jointly sustained.

Convenience can also hide labour. A service that appears instantly on a phone may depend on delivery workers, sanitation staff, data operators and local officials. When citizens demand speed without considering safety, fair conditions or realistic procedures, they transfer the burden of convenience to people with less power. Responsible citizenship therefore includes asking not only whether a service is quick, but whether the method is fair.

Democratic life imposes another kind of effort. It is easier to forward a claim than to verify it, easier to repeat a slogan than to listen to an opponent, and easier to complain privately than to use a public grievance process. Yet citizenship requires judgement. A voter must distinguish evidence from anger; a resident must state a complaint clearly; a community must accept that common rules sometimes limit immediate personal choice. Convenience cannot replace these habits.

This does not mean that institutions should make public life difficult in order to teach discipline. Complicated forms, unnecessary visits and obscure language waste citizens' time and often exclude those with the fewest resources. Well-designed convenience can strengthen citizenship by enabling more people to obtain information, register a grievance or participate in a decision. The crucial question is whether convenience removes pointless friction or removes accountability.

Institutions should therefore design easy services with visible duties and routes for correction. A digital platform can simplify an application while still requiring truthful information. A city can make waste collection reliable while asking households to separate waste. Schools can provide resources while expecting regular effort from learners. In each case, access and responsibility reinforce rather than defeat one another.

Responsibility must also be learnable. Schools, resident groups and public agencies should explain how individual conduct affects a shared result instead of relying only on punishment. People are more likely to cooperate when the rule is simple, the service is reliable and officials follow the same standard. This does not remove personal duty; it places that duty within a credible public relationship.

Citizenship is not proved by accepting inconvenience for its own sake. It is proved by recognising that private ease rests on public cooperation. Convenience strengthens society when it expands fair access; it weakens citizenship when it encourages people to treat common institutions, workers and rules as invisible. A mature society seeks both ease and responsibility, because neither can remain secure without the other.

Why this earns marks: it defines the tension, uses distinct public-space, labour and democratic mechanisms, admits that needless friction is harmful, and returns to a qualified thesis. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Full coaching model 2 - Efficiency is not the same as effectiveness

Efficiency and effectiveness are often praised together, but they answer different questions. Efficiency asks how economically time, money or effort has been used. Effectiveness asks whether the intended result has actually been achieved. A process may be fast and inexpensive yet fail its purpose; another may achieve its purpose while wasting resources. Good administration and good personal judgement require both, but effectiveness must define what efficiency is meant to serve.

The distinction is clear in public services. An office may close thousands of complaints through automatic replies. Its disposal rate will look efficient, but citizens remain without repaired streetlights, corrected records or working water connections. Counting movement is easier than measuring a usable outcome. If the chosen indicator rewards closure rather than solution, staff may rationally improve the number while the public problem continues.

Education provides a similar example. A school can complete the syllabus on time, distribute identical notes and hold examinations according to schedule. These actions may use time efficiently. They are not effective if students cannot explain the ideas or apply them independently. The answer is not to abandon schedules. It is to connect them to learning through feedback, remedial teaching and assessment that reveals understanding.

Efficiency nevertheless matters. Delay can deny justice, increase costs and exhaust citizens who must visit an office repeatedly. A hospital that ignores patient flow may waste scarce clinical time; a transport system that uses fuel carelessly may reduce the service it can provide. Resources are limited, so effectiveness without attention to cost cannot be sustained. The mistake is to treat an easily counted input or output as the final purpose.

This error often appears because efficiency is immediately visible. Managers can count files, minutes and transactions, while effectiveness may require later evidence and the experience of users. Institutions therefore need a balanced set of measures. A clinic should examine not only visits but continuity of treatment; a road agency should examine not only kilometres repaired but safety and durability; a grievance system should examine both response time and final resolution.

The distinction is equally useful in private life. A student may read many pages quickly yet retain little because no time was spent retrieving or applying the ideas. A worker may answer every message immediately while neglecting the difficult task that gives the work value. Here, efficiency improves only when the method is connected to a defined result and reviewed against evidence.

There are also situations in which perfect effectiveness cannot be known in advance. A new programme may operate under uncertainty, and waiting for ideal evidence can itself cause harm. In such cases, institutions should act provisionally, state the objective, monitor consequences and revise the method. Effectiveness is not an excuse for endless delay; it is a discipline of connecting action to purpose.

Efficiency is therefore a means, not a rival, to effectiveness. It prevents waste and protects limited resources, but it becomes dangerous when the measure replaces the mission. A sound system begins with the human or public outcome, selects efficient methods to reach it, and remains willing to change those methods when the evidence shows that fast activity is not useful achievement.

Why this earns marks: it distinguishes the terms, demonstrates proxy risk, recognises resource constraints, supplies a counter-view and ends with an operational synthesis. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Full coaching model 3 - Certainty can be a barrier to learning

Learning requires enough confidence to test an idea, but it also requires the possibility of correction. Certainty becomes a barrier when a person treats a belief as immune to evidence, questions or experience. Such certainty may feel secure, yet it closes the very process through which knowledge grows. The alternative is not permanent confusion; it is disciplined confidence that remains open to revision.

A learner who believes that ability is fixed illustrates the problem. If one poor result is taken as proof of permanent weakness, practice appears useless. The student avoids difficult questions and therefore receives no evidence of improvement. By contrast, a provisional judgement-"I do not yet understand this method"-identifies a present difficulty without turning it into an unchangeable identity. Openness creates room for effort and feedback.

Certainty also narrows attention. People naturally notice facts that support what they already believe. When disagreement is treated as ignorance or bad faith, the learner stops asking what evidence would prove the belief wrong. This is especially harmful in public debate, where complex problems have several causes. A policy may help one group and burden another; a measure may work in one setting and fail in another. Learning begins when these differences are examined rather than dismissed.

Teachers and institutions can reinforce false certainty if they reward only the repetition of conclusions. Memorised answers may produce short-term success, but they do not prepare a student for an unfamiliar question. Education should therefore ask for reasons, comparisons and application. Explaining why an answer is correct exposes gaps that recognition alone can hide.

Conversation is another test. A person may listen only to prepare a reply, assuming that the conclusion is already known. Genuine learning requires restating the other argument fairly and identifying the point on which the disagreement turns. This practice can reveal that a dispute concerns evidence, definitions or values rather than intelligence. Certainty often survives by keeping these differences vague.

However, doubt has limits. A surgeon, engineer or public official cannot postpone every decision until all uncertainty disappears. Nor should well-established evidence be treated as merely one opinion among many. Learning depends on standards: reliable observation, logical consistency and the willingness to compare claims. Openness without such standards becomes indecision or credulity.

The useful distinction is between a conclusion and dogmatism. A conclusion may be firm because evidence presently supports it; dogmatism refuses to name the evidence or conditions under which revision would be justified. The first allows action and future correction. The second protects the believer from learning.

Institutions can encourage this balance by rewarding correction rather than pretending that error is shameful. A classroom in which a revised answer is explained teaches more than one in which only the final mark matters. Public bodies similarly learn when they publish reasons, monitor consequences and admit when a measure has failed. The capacity to correct is a sign of strength, not indecision.

Certainty is therefore a barrier not because knowledge is impossible, but because knowledge is corrigible. A mature learner can say, "This is the best supported answer I have," while still listening for stronger reasons. Such intellectual humility does not weaken judgement. It makes judgement more reliable by ensuring that confidence is earned, tested and capable of growth.

Why this earns marks: the answer separates confidence from dogmatism, develops psychological and institutional mechanisms, answers the objection that action requires decisions, and reaches a qualified conclusion. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Full coaching model 4 - Reading is an exercise in freedom

Freedom is commonly understood as the ability to choose and act without unnecessary restraint. Reading enlarges that freedom at an earlier stage: it expands what a person can imagine, compare and question before choosing. Through reading, a mind can encounter lives, arguments and possibilities beyond its immediate surroundings. This freedom is not automatic, however; it depends on literacy, access, attention and the courage to examine one's own assumptions.

The first freedom created by reading is distance from the present moment. A person absorbed only in immediate experience may mistake local custom for the only possible way of living. History shows that institutions change; literature allows a reader to inhabit another perspective; science explains causes that ordinary observation may miss. These encounters do not dictate a choice, but they make comparison possible. A person who can compare is less easily confined by habit.

Reading also strengthens freedom of judgement. Public life constantly presents claims designed to provoke quick agreement or anger. A careful reader learns to ask who is speaking, what evidence is offered, which words carry emotional force and what has been omitted. This habit slows reaction long enough for judgement to begin. It does not guarantee wisdom, but it reduces dependence on the loudest message.

There is a social dimension as well. Access to rules, notices, contracts and public information allows citizens to understand decisions that affect them. When language is needlessly obscure, formal rights may remain unusable. Libraries, clear public communication and education therefore support freedom not only as culture but as practical access to institutions.

Reading also enlarges the freedom to name experience. A person who finds a precise description of fear, injustice or hope gains language with which to examine it and communicate it to others. This can reduce isolation and make a private difficulty visible as a shared problem. The gain is not merely a larger vocabulary; it is a clearer capacity to think and seek help.

Yet reading can also narrow a person if it becomes passive or exclusive. A reader may consume only material that confirms existing prejudice. Books can contain falsehood, propaganda and inherited injustice. Moreover, the ability to read is unequally distributed when people lack time, schooling, language support or accessible formats. It would be romantic to call reading liberating while ignoring these conditions.

Reading becomes an exercise in freedom when it is active. The reader compares sources, tests claims, notices unfamiliar experience and remains willing to revise an interpretation. Discussion can deepen this process because another reader may see an assumption that the first has missed. The aim is not to replace one authority with unquestioning loyalty to another text.

Digital abundance makes this active discipline more important. Easy access can widen the range of reading, but rapid scrolling can fragment attention and recommendation systems may repeatedly present familiar views. Freedom therefore requires the ability to choose sustained attention, leave a comfortable information circle and verify a striking claim before accepting it.

Reading does not free a person from material constraints by itself. It does, however, enlarge the field of thought within which action becomes possible. By making alternatives visible and judgement more independent, reading creates an inward practice of freedom. Its promise is fulfilled when access is broad and the reader treats every text, including a familiar one, as an invitation to understand rather than an order to obey.

Why this earns marks: the essay explains imaginative, critical and civic freedom, addresses access and propaganda as real limits, and concludes with a qualified account of active reading. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Q2. Model points and practice splits

1. Construction produces a visible asset (5) and an occasion for inauguration (4), whereas maintenance is repetitive and dispersed (3) and therefore less publicly celebrated (3).
2. Small defects first reduce a system's resilience (5). Under heavy rain, high demand or emergency, weaknesses interact (5); the apparent sudden failure is thus accumulated ordinary neglect, not a single event (5).
3. **Financial (7):** capital and maintenance are planned separately (3); funds for staff, parts, supervision and renewal are unpredictable (4). **Institutional (8):** responsibility is fragmented (3), agencies assume another will act (2), and no official has both authority and incentive to repair the defect (3).
4. It means a system records acknowledgement or a registration number while no repair occurs (7). User information becomes effective only with a simple channel (2), acknowledgement (2) and published or visible corrective action (4).
5. **Title:** "Maintenance Is Public Service", "The Ethics of Maintenance", or another title covering the central claim (4). The attitude is strongly approving and corrective (2): maintenance protects past expenditure and prevents harm (4), extends scarce assets (2) and is equitable for people without private alternatives (3).

Q3. Model precis

Count record: source 458 words; one-third target about 153 words; model 155 words. The count excludes the candidate instruction to record rough-work counts. This is a practice calculation, not a published tolerance.

Modern life often equates speed with competence because rapid communication and delivery can save lives, cut costs and connect people. Yet valuable decisions require attention, verification and judgement. In medicine, justice and journalism, action without adequate evidence can cause harm that later correction cannot undo. Digital systems intensify this risk by making approval, sharing and acceptance effortless while leaving responsibility unchanged. Institutions must distinguish idle delay, caused by neglect or pointless procedure, from deliberation, which gathers evidence, compares claims and records reasons. They should remove waiting but protect stages where thought improves decisions. They must also ensure that difficult cases are not discarded merely to improve figures. Measures based only on closures, examinations or turnover can reward superficial completion instead of real outcomes. Individuals also need pauses before forwarding claims, reacting in anger or making irreversible choices. The alternative to haste is not procrastination but disciplined timeliness: acting when knowledge, authority and safeguards are sufficient.

Accept accurate, coherent versions close to the instructed proportion. Deduct diagnostically for omitted concessions, unsupported additions, copied wording, disconnected notes, wrong title instruction or material count failure.

Q4

A

1. One of the files **is** missing.
2. capable **of solving**
3. discussed the proposal
4. **Preferred conservative examination edit:** Neither of the alternatives **is** acceptable. **Variant policy:** *Neither alternative is acceptable* earns full credit. Plural *are* after *neither of* is documented in modern use and may be credited only where the test's declared house style accepts it; for this conservative correction test, prefer singular **is**.
5. returned from Delhi
6. furniture ... **is**
7. waiting **for** three hours
8. No sooner **had** the bell rung than...
9. **Preferred conservative examination edit:** The reason is **that** funding was delayed. **Variant policy:** *The reason is because funding was delayed* occurs in modern English but may be rejected as redundant by conservative examination keys; credit it only under a documented house style that accepts it. *Funding was delayed because...*

is a fully acceptable recast when a rewrite rather than minimal correction is permitted.

10. Each candidate must bring **his or her** admit card. Singular **their** is accepted where the sentence is otherwise clear and consistent; do not penalise it merely for being gender-neutral.

B

with, from, for, from, on

C

had ended; works; was reading; moves; has been serving

D

opaque, abundant, compulsory, flexible, permanent

Q5

A

1. The survey was completed by the team.
2. She said that she had submitted the form.
3. Hardly had the rain stopped when work resumed.
4. Unless you listen, you will misunderstand.
5. He was too weak to walk.
6. He is not only honest but also efficient.
7. In spite of the task being difficult, she completed it.
8. aren't they?
9. **It being a holiday, the office was closed.**
10. Meera checked only the accounts.

Equivalent grammatical transformations that preserve tense, agent and meaning should be accepted. Do not accept a dangling construction in which the **office** is represented as "being a holiday."

B. Meaning, form and self-marking boundary

Word	Required form and meaning	Natural model sentence	Accept / reject
prudent	adjective: wisely cautious; showing good judgement	<i>A prudent applicant kept copies of every document.</i>	Accept a clear adjective use meaning cautious/judicious; reject "careful" if context does not show judgement.
alleviate	transitive verb: make pain, hardship or severity less	<i>The extra water supply helped alleviate the shortage.</i>	Accept correct inflections; reject "eliminate completely" or noun use where a verb is required.
reluctant	adjective, commonly <i>reluctant to + verb</i> : unwilling or hesitant	<i>Reluctant to sign without evidence, she asked for time.</i>	Accept unwilling/hesitant; reject "eager" or a sentence where hesitation is absent.
impartial	adjective: fair; not favouring either side	<i>An impartial officer heard both complaints before deciding.</i>	Accept neutral/fair if the sentence demonstrates equal treatment; reject "uninterested" when it means careless.
feasible	adjective: practicable or capable of being done	<i>The engineer showed that the repair was feasible within the available time.</i>	Accept practicable/viable; reject merely "desirable" or an adverb/noun substitution.

C

complement, stationery, principle, affect, discreet

D. Meaning, form and self-marking boundary

Expression	Meaning and form	Natural model sentence	Accept / reject
at sea	idiomatic adjective phrase: confused or uncertain	<i>Without the map, I was at sea.</i>	Accept uncertainty/confusion; reject a literal sea voyage unless the figurative meaning is also clear.
cut corners	verb phrase: save time/money improperly by lowering standards	<i>The contractor cut corners on safety checks.</i>	Reject efficient economy that does not imply improper reduced standards.
a blessing in disguise	noun phrase: an apparent setback later proves beneficial	<i>The delayed launch was a blessing in disguise because it exposed the fault.</i>	Reject an event that is simply pleasant from the beginning.
A stitch in time saves nine	proverb: early action prevents a larger problem	<i>The clerk repaired the minor error at once; a stitch in time saves nine.</i>	A complete proverb may stand alone; reject use that implies delay is preferable.
All that glitters is not gold	proverb: attractive appearance can conceal poor value	<i>The impressive offer carried hidden costs; all that glitters is not gold.</i>	A complete proverb may stand alone; reject literal use without the cautionary meaning.

PART 03 - English Full-Length Mock 2 - Key and Rubric

One-to-one coverage ledger

Workbook unit	Items/options	Solutions supplied
Q1 essay choices	4	4 full coaching models
Q2 comprehension	5	5 passage-grounded answers
Q3 precis	1	1 counted model
Q4A / Q4B / Q4C / Q4D	10 / 5 / 5 / 5	10 / 5 / 5 / 5
Q5A / Q5B / Q5C / Q5D	10 / 5 / 5 / 5	10 / 5 / 5 / 5

These are coaching solutions and accepted-answer ranges, not an official UPSC key.

Q1. Essay rubric

Use the Mock 1 anchored bands. A high-band answer decodes the exact proposition, states a qualified thesis in the introduction, develops distinct mechanisms, tests a real limitation, uses safe examples analytically and finishes near 600 words with a reasoned verdict.

Planning anchors

Prompt	Defensible qualified thesis
Rules acquire legitimacy...	Enforcement is necessary, but a rule gains durable legitimacy when people can understand its purpose, application and route of challenge.
The ability to listen...	Listening is public responsibility because decisions affect people unequally; it requires conditions for informed dissent, not passive silence.
Progress should enlarge...	Progress is incomplete if more options are offered without the education, time and institutions needed for considered judgement.
A city is made...	Buildings enable urban life, but shared habits of care, rule-following and coexistence determine whether the city remains liveable.

Full coaching model 1 - Rules acquire legitimacy when they are understandable as well as enforceable

A rule can be enforced because an authority has the power to punish disobedience. Legitimacy asks a deeper question: do people have reason to regard the rule and its application as justified? Enforcement is necessary for many laws, but durable legitimacy grows when people can understand the rule's purpose, know what conduct it requires and use a fair route to question an error. A command that is powerful but unintelligible may secure temporary obedience without earning public trust.

Clarity matters first because a person cannot follow an unknown obligation. Notices written in obscure language, procedures scattered across offices or frequently changing digital forms shift the cost of administration onto the citizen. This burden is unequal: those with time, education or professional help can manage confusion more easily. Plain language and accessible guidance do not weaken a rule. They make equal compliance more possible.

Understanding purpose also supports voluntary cooperation. Traffic rules are not legitimate merely because a fine can be imposed; their public purpose is to coordinate movement and reduce danger. When the reason is visible, citizens can connect personal restraint with common safety. Explanation is especially important when a rule imposes inconvenience or distributes scarce resources. People may still disagree, but disagreement differs from arbitrary treatment when reasons can be examined.

Application must be intelligible as well. A clear rule can lose legitimacy if officials apply it selectively or give no reasons for an exception. Consistent procedure, written decisions and an appeal route show that enforcement is controlled by standards rather than personal favour. They also help the institution discover mistakes. An unexplained penalty demands submission; a reasoned order can be reviewed and corrected.

Participation can improve both clarity and compliance. People affected by a rule may identify a practical obstacle that its authors did not see. A short consultation cannot transfer final authority to every participant, but it can test whether the wording is workable and whether the burden falls unfairly on one group. Publishing the response to such objections demonstrates that explanation is connected to decision rather than added as decoration.

There are limits to explanation. Emergency action may be required before a long consultation is possible, and some technical rules cannot be reduced to a slogan without losing accuracy. Nor does understanding make every rule morally acceptable. A plainly explained unjust rule remains unjust. Legitimacy therefore requires substantive fairness in addition to clarity.

Still, institutions should treat comprehension as part of implementation. They can publish short explanations, provide assistance, test whether users understand a process and record why exceptions are made. Enforcement then becomes the final safeguard for a known public rule, not a substitute for communication.

This approach also improves enforcement itself. When duties and exceptions are understood, accidental violations decline and officials can focus on deliberate evasion. Clear reasons create a public standard against which both citizens and enforcers can be judged, reducing the space for arbitrary bargaining.

Rules acquire legitimacy when authority is joined to reasons. Enforceability protects society from deliberate violation; understandability allows ordinary people to comply, criticise and seek correction. A legitimate order therefore does not merely ask whether citizens obey. It also asks whether public power has made its demands clear, fair and answerable.

Why this earns marks: it distinguishes legal force from legitimacy, develops clarity, purpose and review, recognises emergency and injustice limits, and returns to a qualified thesis. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Full coaching model 2 - The ability to listen is a form of public responsibility

Listening is often treated as personal courtesy, but in public life it is a responsibility. Decisions made by officials, professionals and community leaders affect people whose experience may not be visible in reports. To listen is not merely to remain silent while another person speaks. It is to create a fair opportunity for relevant voices to be understood, weighed and answered before power is exercised.

The responsibility begins with information. A policy designed without hearing users may solve the problem imagined by the institution rather than the problem people actually face. A bus timetable can look adequate on paper while workers know that a missed connection makes it unusable. Nurses may notice that equipment recorded as available cannot function. Listening turns such experience into evidence and allows correction before failure becomes normal.

Listening also gives dignity to disagreement. A citizen who receives an unfavourable decision may still recognise the process as fair if the reasons have been heard and answered. By contrast, a formal consultation can deepen distrust when the outcome appears fixed in advance. Public responsibility therefore requires more than inviting comments. It requires clear questions, accessible language, a record of objections and an explanation of how they affected the decision.

Power makes listening difficult. A junior employee may not contradict a superior in a crowded meeting; a person unfamiliar with technical language may remain silent; a marginal group may lack representation altogether. Responsible institutions use more than one format-written submissions, smaller meetings, field observation or anonymous feedback-so that silence is not automatically mistaken for consent.

Listening does not mean surrendering judgement. Governments cannot wait for unanimity, judges must decide between competing claims and emergency services must sometimes act before consultation is complete. Nor is every demand equally supported by evidence. The duty is to consider relevant reasons, not to accept every preference. Firm decisions and genuine listening can coexist when the authority explains what it accepted, what it rejected and why.

Good listening also requires response. Repeating a person's words without changing an incorrect assumption or explaining a refusal can become a ritual of politeness. The listener should identify the issue understood, separate what can be acted upon from what cannot, and state the next step. This closes the loop and lets the speaker correct a misunderstanding before it hardens into a decision.

Citizens also bear this responsibility. Democratic discussion fails when people demand a hearing for themselves but caricature an opponent. Listening can reveal a shared concern beneath different proposals and can also show that a disagreement is real and cannot be removed by polite language. In both cases, it improves judgement.

The habit begins in ordinary institutions. A teacher who asks why an answer was chosen, a doctor who checks whether instructions were understood and a local office that records repeated complaints all convert speech into usable knowledge. Small listening practices can prevent larger errors because they make correction normal rather than exceptional.

The ability to listen is public responsibility because power acts under conditions of incomplete knowledge. Listening supplies experience, tests assumptions and makes correction possible. It should not paralyse action, but it should prevent authority from confusing its own convenience with the public interest.

Why this earns marks: it explains listening as evidence, dignity and institutional design, treats unequal speaking conditions, answers the unanimity objection and concludes in terms of accountable power. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Full coaching model 3 - Progress should enlarge human judgement, not merely human choice

Progress is often measured by the number of options available: more products, more information, more channels of communication and more ways to organise daily life. Choice can enlarge freedom, but choice alone does not ensure that a person can recognise consequences or select well. Progress is more complete when it develops human judgement-the ability to understand alternatives, compare reasons and revise decisions-rather than merely multiplying options.

An abundance of information illustrates the difference. A learner with access to thousands of pages may possess more choices than an earlier generation, yet remain unable to distinguish reliable evidence from confident assertion. Search tools reduce the cost of finding material; education must still teach how to interpret it. Without that capacity, greater choice can produce confusion or dependence on whatever appears first.

Consumer life presents a similar problem. A digital platform can display many offers while designing the screen to favour an impulsive selection. Long, obscure conditions formally preserve choice but weaken informed consent. Progress should therefore be judged not only by availability but by whether people can understand price, risk and alternatives. Clear information and time for reconsideration enlarge real agency.

Public services also need judgement. Moving an application online may offer a new channel, but citizens require language support, digital confidence and a way to correct an error. If these conditions are absent, the apparent choice between online options may conceal practical exclusion. Institutions must measure successful use, not merely registrations.

It would be mistaken, however, to oppose choice and judgement. Restricted choices can protect privilege and deny experimentation. People often learn by trying alternatives, and new technology can expose them to ideas and opportunities that were previously inaccessible. The aim is not to let an authority choose on behalf of everyone. It is to provide education, transparent design and accountable institutions so that choice becomes meaningful.

The quality of judgement is also collective. An individual cannot personally verify every medicine, financial product or technical standard. Trustworthy institutions reduce this burden through testing, disclosure and remedies. Such safeguards do not remove choice; they create a reliable environment in which ordinary people can exercise it without mastering every specialised field.

Judgement also includes the ability to limit oneself. A person may have the choice to share an unverified message, consume without restraint or respond immediately in anger. Progress is shown when social norms and personal habits support reflection before action. Such restraint is not the enemy of freedom; it protects the conditions under which freedom can be exercised without avoidable harm.

Education is therefore central. It should not merely deliver information but train comparison, inference, numerical sense and ethical reflection. A person who can ask what an option excludes, who benefits and whether an error can be reversed possesses a freedom more durable than access to an endlessly expanding menu.

Human progress therefore cannot be counted only by menus, devices or transactions. These may be valuable means, but the deeper measure is whether people gain the knowledge, time and institutional support needed to choose with understanding. Choice opens doors; judgement helps a person decide which door to enter and accept responsibility for what follows.

Why this earns marks: it separates formal choice from real agency, uses information, consumer and service examples, preserves the value of choice, and offers a qualified synthesis. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Full coaching model 4 - A city is made not only by buildings but by shared habits

Buildings give a city its visible form. Roads, homes, markets, drains, schools and hospitals make dense settlement possible. Yet physical structures do not by themselves create an urban community. A liveable city also depends on shared habits: respecting public space, following workable rules, cooperating with strangers and expecting institutions to maintain common services. Buildings provide capacity; habits determine how that capacity is used and preserved.

Consider mobility. A wide road cannot ensure orderly movement if drivers ignore lanes, pedestrians cannot cross safely and parked vehicles occupy public space. Rules help, but enforcement alone cannot supervise every action. Daily habits of yielding, queuing and recognising the equal claim of another road user turn infrastructure into a functioning system.

Cleanliness shows the same relationship. Waste collection requires vehicles, workers and treatment facilities. It also requires households and businesses to store and hand over waste responsibly. If littering is treated as someone else's problem, the city spends scarce resources correcting conduct that could have been prevented. Shared care is therefore not decoration; it extends the life and usefulness of infrastructure.

Cities also depend on habits of coexistence. People of different languages, occupations and incomes use the same transport, markets and neighbourhoods. Urban freedom requires tolerance of difference, but it also requires limits on noise, obstruction and conduct that makes common space unusable. Courtesy is not enough when rights are violated, yet ordinary restraint reduces the number of conflicts that must be settled by force.

Shared habits are especially visible during stress. Heavy rain, a transport failure or a public-health emergency tests whether residents spread rumours, block access and compete blindly, or share reliable information and protect the most vulnerable. Infrastructure determines what help is possible, while social trust determines whether that help can reach people in time. Everyday cooperation builds the reserve needed for exceptional moments.

Institutions shape these habits. Citizens are less likely to follow a rule that is confusing, selectively enforced or unsupported by a usable service. A city cannot demand careful waste disposal without reliable collection, or traffic discipline while allowing unsafe road design. Public authorities must provide infrastructure, explain rules and respond consistently. Shared habits are jointly produced by citizens and institutions.

There is a danger in using the language of civic habits to blame residents for structural failure. No amount of patience can replace water supply, affordable housing or safe public transport. Poor communities may be forced into informal arrangements because formal systems exclude them. The responsibility of the state to build and maintain equitable infrastructure therefore remains fundamental.

At the same time, participation can improve those structures. Residents who report a failing streetlight, protect a neighbourhood water point or attend a local meeting provide information that distant agencies may miss. Such action works only when authorities acknowledge it and publish what was done, but it shows how civic habits can become practical urban maintenance.

A city is made when physical systems and social conduct support one another. Buildings without cooperation decay into congestion, exclusion and neglect; goodwill without infrastructure cannot meet material needs. The truly urban achievement is a shared environment in which public investment is reliable and everyday behaviour recognises that millions of private journeys depend on common rules and mutual care.

Why this earns marks: it covers mobility, cleanliness and coexistence, adds institutional responsibility, rejects victim-blaming, and concludes by joining material and civic dimensions. This is a coaching model, not an official UPSC key.

Q2. Model points and practice splits

1. The data must be accurate **(3)**, carefully interpreted **(4)**, connected to a decision **(4)**, and owned by someone responsible for making that decision **(4)**.
2. A record can be factually accurate yet measure an inadequate proxy rather than the relevant outcome **(8)**. For example, attendance does not establish learning, or clinic visits do not establish completed treatment **(7)**.
3. Numbers are simplified representations and should not be mistaken for the fuller lived condition they measure **(8)**. In public services this can reward an attractive number while excluding unmeasured harm, especially for people unable to complain or switch services **(7)**.
4. The tone is **qualified and cautionary**, not anti-data **(3)**. Targets can clarify purpose and improve performance **(6)**, but can distort behaviour when the number is rewarded instead of the purpose **(6)**.
5. Suitable titles include *"Measure Without Losing Meaning"* or *"Data Needs Judgement"* **(4)**. The examples show, across education, health and transport, that a single number can miss the service outcome it is meant to represent **(6)**; they make the abstract warning concrete **(3)** and demonstrate that the problem applies across public institutions **(2)**.

Q3. Model precis

Count record: source **246** words; one-third target **about 82** words; model **83** words.

Silence in public life cannot safely be treated as consent because it may reflect agreement, fear, confusion or exclusion. A formal invitation to comment does not ensure that participants can influence a decision: they may lack confidence, technical language or belief that dissent matters. Listening therefore requires checking understanding, representation, candid formats and minority reasons. Although action cannot await unanimity and may sometimes be urgent, institutions should distinguish informed acceptance from silence caused by exclusion so that firm decisions remain open to correction.

Q4

A

1. The list of eligible candidates **is** displayed outside.
2. She has been living here **for** five years.
3. The report was divided **into** four sections.
4. He insisted **on inspecting** the original file.
5. Neither Rohan nor his friends **were** willing to wait.
6. The manager suggested **that I apply again** / suggested **applying again**.
7. Having finished the audit, **the auditors reported the errors**.
8. I prefer walking **to** taking a crowded bus.
9. **Acceptable**. Singular **their** is standard modern formal English and the singular **form** matches the one form required from each employee. **His or her** and a clear plural recast also receive credit.
10. The committee discussed the delay.

B

to, with, on, of, from

C

leaves; was preparing; will have completed; seems; have not seen

D

accidental, contract, reveal, superior, permanent

Q5

A

1. The result will be announced by the board tomorrow.
2. The teacher told the students not to copy the answer.
3. No sooner had the officer arrived than the meeting began.
4. Unless you check the source, you may share an error.
5. The bag is too heavy for her to carry.
6. He is not only diligent but also careful.
7. In spite of the route being long, they continued walking.
8. shall we?
9. Being narrow, the road made the bus move slowly.
10. The chairperson signed only the minutes.

Accept grammatical equivalents that preserve the required transformation and meaning. In Q5A9, do not accept a dangling form that makes the bus the road's modifier.

B. Meaning, form and self-marking boundary

Word	Required form and meaning	Natural model sentence	Accept / reject
coherent	adjective: logical, connected and easy to follow	<i>The report presented a coherent account of the delay.</i>	Accept logical/well-connected; reject simply "loud" or "lengthy."
mitigate	transitive verb: make a harm, risk or severity less serious	<i>Shade trees can mitigate the effect of extreme heat.</i>	Accept correct verb inflections; reject "remove completely" or a noun used in place of the verb.
tentative	adjective: provisional, uncertain or not final	<i>The committee reached a tentative agreement pending review.</i>	Accept provisional/uncertain; reject confident/final.
resilient	adjective: able to recover, adapt or continue after difficulty	<i>The resilient network restored service after the disruption.</i>	Accept recovery/adaptation sense; reject "fragile" or a merely strong physical object without recovery meaning.
obsolete	adjective: no longer current or useful because replaced	<i>The office replaced its obsolete filing system.</i>	Accept out-of-date/superseded; reject merely old if it remains useful.

C

elicit, exceed, credible, effect, together

D. Meaning, form and self-marking boundary

Expression	Meaning and form	Natural model sentence	Accept / reject
Look before you leap.	proverb: consider consequences before acting	<i>Before accepting the contract, she compared its conditions; look before you leap.</i>	A complete proverb may stand alone; reject use praising impulsiveness.
a thorn in the flesh	noun phrase: a persistent source of irritation or trouble	<i>The recurring leak became a thorn in the administration's flesh.</i>	Accept enduring annoyance/problem; reject a one-time minor inconvenience.
know the ins and outs	verb phrase: know all the details of a system or matter	<i>The clerk knows the ins and outs of the application process.</i>	Accept detailed practical knowledge; reject a literal inside/outside meaning.
Where there is a will, there is a way.	proverb: determination can help overcome obstacles	<i>They kept revising their plan because where there is a will, there is a way.</i>	A complete proverb may stand alone; reject a claim that desire guarantees success without effort.
go berserk	verb phrase: become wildly uncontrolled, angry or excited	<i>The crowd did not go berserk; it left the venue calmly.</i>	Accept an uncontrolled-reaction sense; reject a casual synonym for "work hard" or "go quickly."